Flying Crane

Original design by Mackenzie Bruce

Created October 4, 2026 - (c) 2026 Mackenzie Bruce

Guide assembled by Muse

DESIGN SHEET - v1.0



About this model

An experiment of the basic bird body: a classic bird base transformed with an accordion-pleated zigzag neck, pleated swept wings, and a fanned tail, posed in flight. The pleated neck is the model's signature - no other published crane combines it with the flying pose.

- Paper: duo or striped kami shows off the pleats
- Size: 15 cm or larger
- Difficulty: low-intermediate (designer's rating)

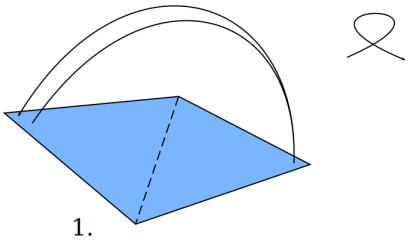
How this sheet is organized

The model starts from a traditional bird base - the shared foundation. Everything original happens after: the pleated neck and head, the wings, and the tail. So this sheet diagrams only what's new.

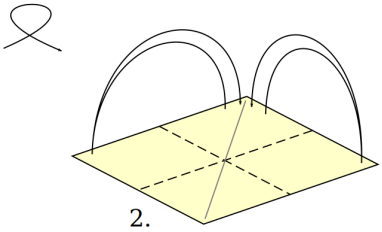
- 1. Base - fold a traditional bird base (below).
- 2. Neck & head - accordion pleats + beak (to be documented).
- 3. Wings - lengthwise pleats, swept back (to be documented).
- 4. Tail - narrowed, fanned, shaped tip (to be documented).
- 5. Body - unfold and fold inward, locking against the neck (to be documented).

1 - The base

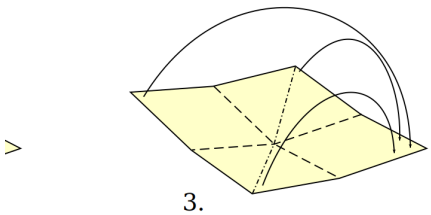
Fold a traditional bird base from your square. Diagrams by Ftiercel, public domain via Wikimedia Commons.



1.

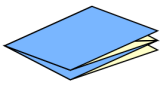


2.



3.

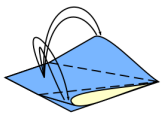
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4.

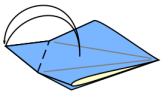
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5.

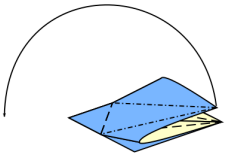


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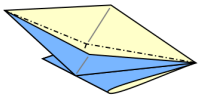
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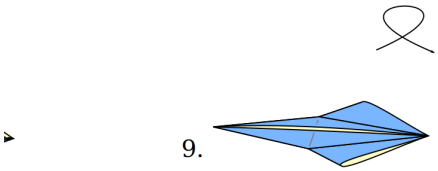


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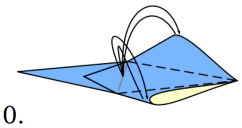


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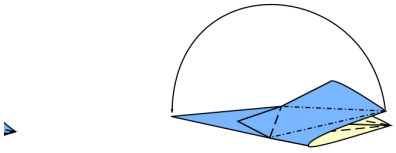




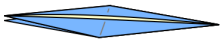
9.



10.



11.



12.

Bird base complete. The four flaps become: head (top), tail (bottom), wings (left and right).

Bird base diagrams: Ftiercel, public domain, via Wikimedia Commons.

2 - Neck & head [PHOTO-DOCUMENTED]

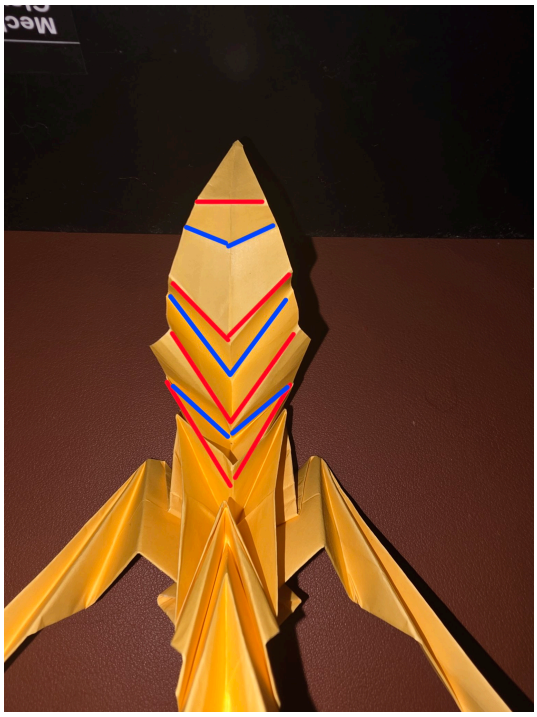
Documented from the designer's refold, October 12, 2026.

2a - Accordion-pleat the neck



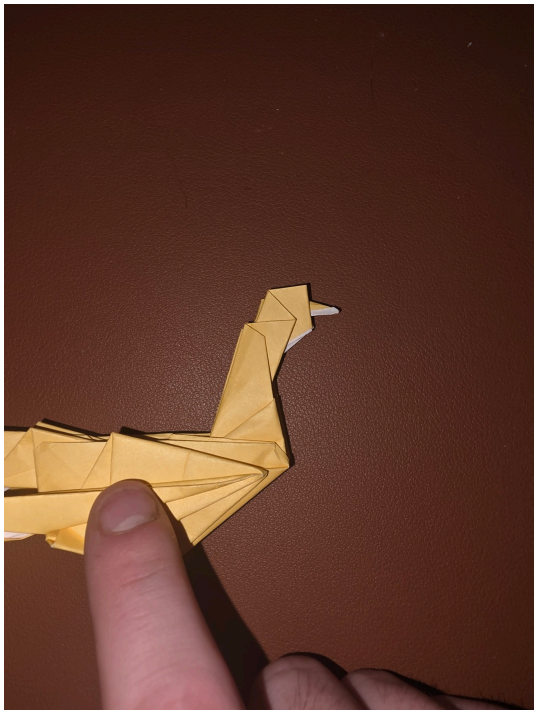
Pleat the head flap into a stack of chevron-shaped accordion pleats running up the neck, alternating mountain and valley.





Designer's mountain/valley map for the neck: red = mountain folds (ridges), blue = valley folds (grooves). First photo viewed from beneath, second from above.

2b - Fold the beak



Shape the tip of the flap into the beak with a small inside reverse fold - the beak is included in the neck markings above.

3 - Wings [PHOTO-DOCUMENTED]

Documented from the designer's refold, October 12, 2026.

3a - Spread the wing flap out flat

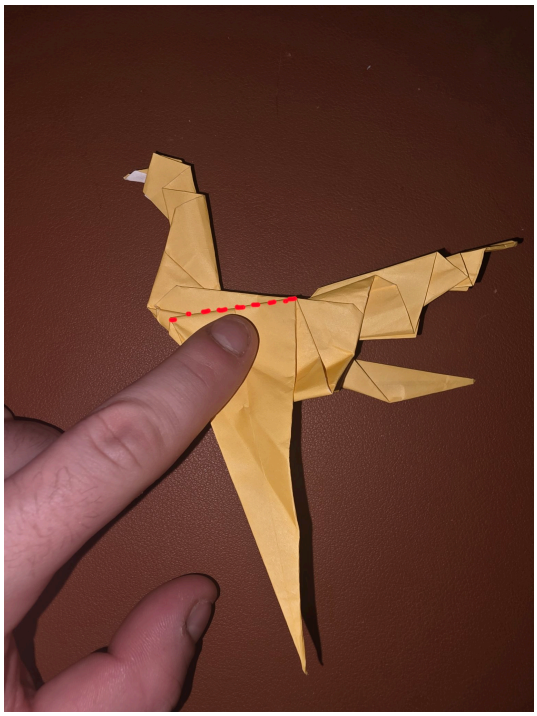


Open the wing flap out flat to the side, away from the body.

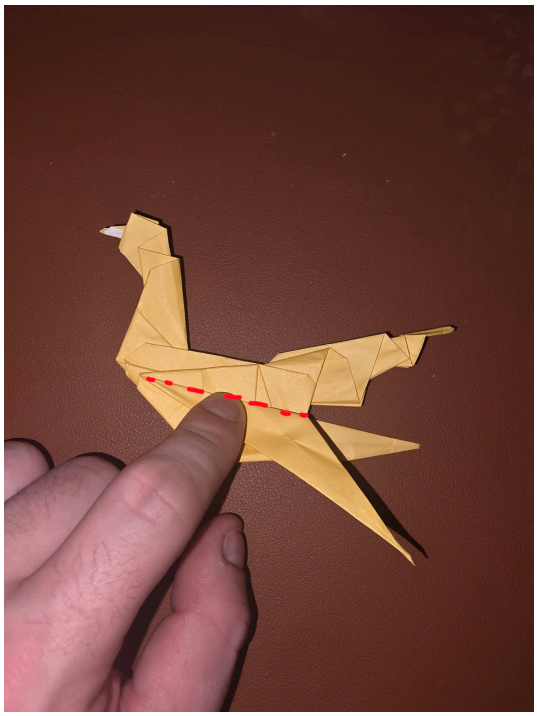
3b - Pleat the wing lengthwise

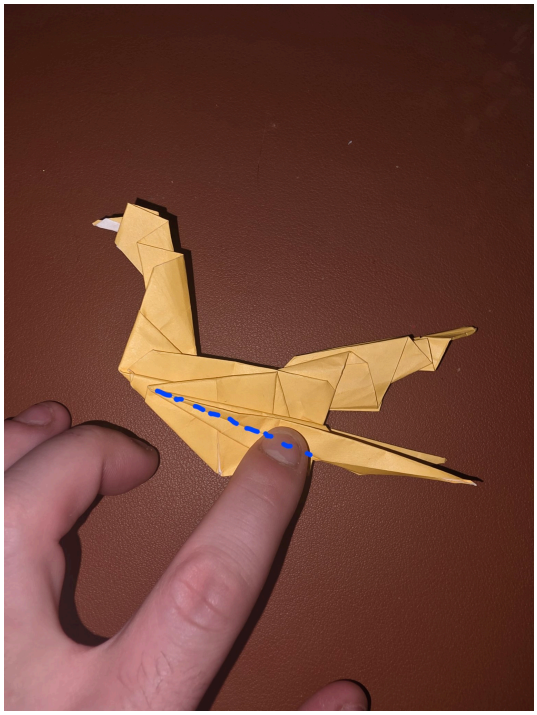


Accordion-pleat the wing along its length, following the crease pattern - the pleats fan toward the wingtip, alternating mountain and valley.









Designer's fold map, in order: red dashed = mountain folds, blue dashed = valley folds.

3c - Sweep the wing back into position



Fold the pleated wing back against the body into the swept flying pose. Repeat for the second wing.

4 - Tail [PHOTO-DOCUMENTED]

Documented from the designer's refold, October 12, 2026.

4a - Narrow the tail flap



Narrow the tail flap with petal-fold-like creases, tapering it toward the tip.



Designer's mountain/valley map for the tail: red = mountain folds (ridges), blue = valley folds (grooves). These markings show where the narrowing folds go.

4b - Fan and shape the tip





Fan the tail with short diagonal creases and shape the tip with small reverse folds.

5 - Body: unfold and fold inward [PHOTO-DOCUMENTED]

Documented from the designer's refold, October 12, 2026. This step comes after the wings, tail, and head are made.

5a - Unfold the body



Unfold the body back to its flat crease pattern, spreading the layers out to expose the inside structure.

5b - Fold the flaps inward



Valley-fold the side flaps inwards to the center line, so the folds sit up against the neck and the head, locking the body around the neck.



Designer's fold map for the body: blue = valley folds (inward), red = mountain fold (outward ridge).

5c - Tuck the front feet

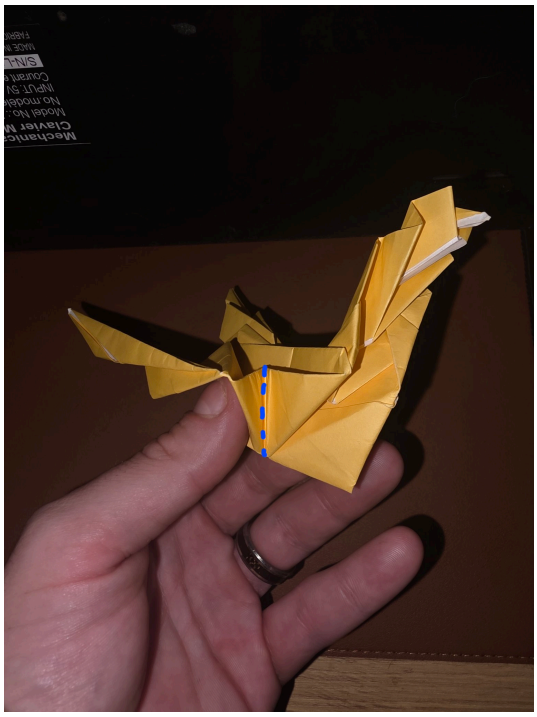




Fold the front feet back against the body.



Spread the wing out.



Fold the wing back in between the body and the wing.

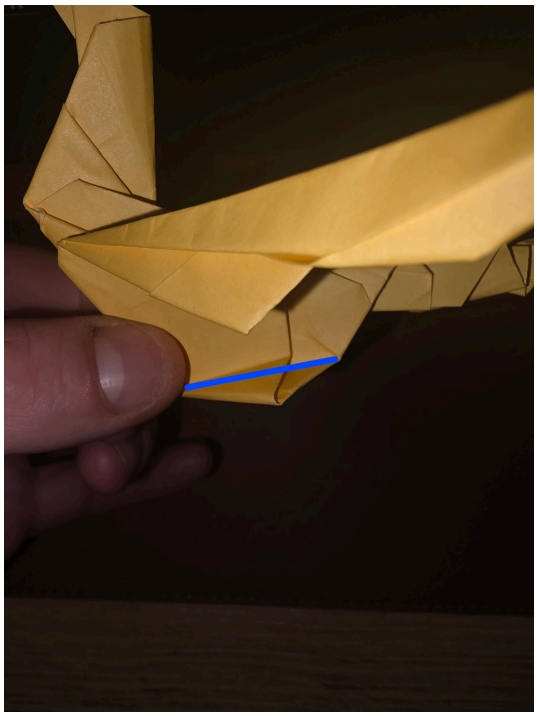


Repeat on the other side. Both sides finished.

5d - Form the back feet/stand









Fold the back feet into a stand that holds the crane up - red = mountain folds, blue = valley folds.

5e - The finished fold



The completed Flying Crane, seen from behind - pleated wings spread, fanned tail below.

Finished product

Original design by Mackenzie Bruce, folded October 12, 2026.





